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Hazmat Security Threat Assessment (STA)

Hazardous Materials (hazmat) pose an inherent risk when being transported on highways. Any accidental spill can impact the health of people, animals, and the environment, sometimes for months, or even years after the incident. Hazmat employers and employees are required under USDOT to complete in-depth security and safety training. Additionally, due to this potentially very high risk, a driver cannot qualify to transport hazardous materials if they pose a threat to the security of the nation.

Background Checks

The U. S. Patriot Act requires the Transportation Security Administration (TSA) to complete a Hazmat (HME) Security Threat Assessment (STA) for a background and fingerprint-based check before a HazMat endorsement is issued.

When a customer applies for a Hazardous Materials Endorsement (HME), the customer must first complete a HME Security Threat Assessment (STA). They will apply in person or via Department of Homeland Security/Transportation Security Administration website (universalenroll.dhs.gov).



Once approved, the background check is valid for **up to five years**, regardless of how long the actual CDL credential is valid.

Background Checks on Renewal HME Applicants

If the customer's background check is expired and they are renewing it they will apply again with the Transportation Security Administration. They will need to return when the background check is completed and clears, the Transportation Security Administration reports the Security Threat Response information to ADOT and the approved response is manually added by MVD Support Services. View the [TSA Responses and Meanings](#) chart for more information on the approved responses.

The customer can go to the Department of Homeland Security/Transportation Security Administration website to check status (universalenroll.dhs.gov).

Out-of-State CDL Holders with HME

When an out-of-state driver applies for a commercial license with a Hazmat endorsement, and they currently have that endorsement, the HME Security Threat Assessment (STA) needs to be updated in MAX with the current TSA Security Threat Response. When you send a customer away to complete

their CDL knowledge test(s), have an upline approver submit a [Service Portal](#) ticket to Tech Support to have the CDL Helpdesk make an inquiry with STA/Hazmat.

View the [Credential Issuance - CDL Scenarios](#) topic > Issuing Out of State CDL Transfer (with Hazmat) section for full steps.

TSA Responses and Meanings

Response Message	Okay to Issue Hazardous Materials Endorsement (Yes/No)
No security threat, approved	Yes
Approved, OOS Transfer	Yes
Approved, 90 Day Ext	Yes
Final determination of security threat, no approved	No
Immediate revocation, not approved	No

Eligibility Requirements

The eligibility qualifications for a HME are:

- Valid CDL or applying for a CDL
- Must be 21 years of age or older
- Application for CDL with Hazardous Materials Endorsement (HME)
- Apply to Transportation Security Administration for a HME Security Threat Assessment (STA)

- Must pass appropriate [CDL Entry Level Driver Training](#) requirements
- Pass and complete all appropriate CDL written and skills tests, if applicable
- After completion of the CDL skills test, the applicant may choose to receive a CDL without the HME until the Transportation Security Administration approval is received to which the customer will return to the MVD for issuance

View the [Commercial Driver License \(CDL\) Endorsements](#) topic > [Hazardous Materials Endorsement \(HME\)](#) section for more information on testing requirements with HME endorsements.

▶ **Issuing a CDL With a TSA Hazmat Endorsement**

HELPFUL LINKS

» [MVD / DMV Public Website](#) »

» [Customer Portal](#) »

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